

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

2000-73

CFO-ORC FILE #

7-0 A

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

Red 1/3/00 wyl

Species: Eurasian Collared-Dove (*Streptopelia decaocto*)

Date: 17 December 2000

Number seen: two

Sex: ?

Plumage: Basic

Locality: North Circle in Cañon City

Elevation: ~5332'

Nearest town: Cañon City

County: Fremont

Time observed: about 08:00 - 08:05

Duration of observation: about five minutes

Description: Stan Oswald and I were assigned the duty of finding the Eurasian Collared-Dove for the Penrose, CO, CBC that had been present for 3+ months. We were given specific directions to the bird by the compilers, which we followed and immediately found the bird. Only, there were two of them. There had, apparently, been a Ringed Turtle-Dove and a possible hybrid around previously (I reviewed pictures of the birds earlier in the year), but we could not find either of those. We saw both birds very well perched and somewhat in flight, though one of them only very briefly in flight. The two birds were enough identical that I here describe them as one.

A large, pale dove that was mostly pale gray-brown all over and being a bit darker and browner above than below. It had an obvious black bar on the back of the neck that was bordered top and bottom by thin, white bars. The eyes were reddish and the bill black (and of typical dove length). The primaries were much darker (almost blackish) than the rest of the wing and contrasted strongly with the gray secondaries and greater coverts. In combination with these features, the brownish lesser coverts created a tri-colored wing. The tail was white below with black bases to at least the outer pair or so of rectrices. The outermost rectrix on each side was black for about $\frac{1}{2}$ to $\frac{1}{3}$ of the outer web, with this black extending further down the feather than the black on the inner web of the same feather. The black on the inner web of the outer rectrices extended about to the tip of the longest undertail coverts, which were grayish.

Similar species eliminated by description: Ringed Turtle-Dove (and presumably hybrids with that "form") have a much-less-obvious wing pattern and much less black on the underside of the tail - resulting in an obviously-different pattern. Other *Streptopelia* doves are also eliminated by the combination of plumage features described above. No other species are at all similar.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): none heard

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen 100s, including >75 in CO, of Eurasian Collared-Doves and 100s of Ringed Turtle-Doves (in captivity and in the "wild"). I have seen one or two other species of *Streptopelia* in captivity a couple of times.

Light conditions: sun behind me and somewhat to my right

Optical equipment used: Swarovski 8.5x42

Distance, and how estimated: estimated at ~18 meters to one bird and ~21 meters to the other

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Stan Oswald

Other observers who saw the bird independently: quite a few observers saw one of the birds earlier in the year, including SeEtta Moss, Jim & Rosie Watts, and David Pantle

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph.

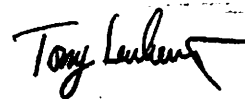
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:



Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 2 January 2001, from notes written shortly after sighting